Ranganath was staying. Sivarasan, along with Shubha, Nero, Suresh Master, Amman (Trichy Santhan's wireless operator) and Rangan (who was helping Trichy Santhan arrange transport for shifting injured cadres from hospital to hospital), got out of the Gypsy and sneaked into their new hideout.[10]

Ranganath's entry into the scene turned out to be an obstacle for the SIT. He was not a regular member of the LTTE and didn't figure in any record of either the intelligence bureau or the Bangalore Police. Tracking Suresh Master through him, therefore, was not possible. The trail the SIT was following had snapped, giving Sivarasan enough time to plan his next move. And Ranganath had no clue about the real identity of Suresh Master's 'injured friends'. He had only let his house be used in an attempt to wriggle out of his financial issues.[11]

Suresh Master had kept the carrot dangling in front of Ranganath by offering him more financial help against new accommodations. Suresh Master knew the situation was becoming hot for him and could not risk going around looking for a new house. Ranganath helped him for money. The Tamil activist secured another house in Anekal. Suresh Master found it crowded, so he suggested that Ranganath continue his search. He found two new places within two days—at Biroota and Muthati in Madya district. Ranganath understood that Suresh Master's 'injured friends' were LTTE cadres who had sustained injuries in Jaffna. Their interactions had made it easy for Ranganath. He also understood that the rest were none other than the assassins of Rajiv Gandhi. Identifying Sivarasan or Shubha was no rocket science in those days. He knew he would face questions from the landlords about the identity of so many injured people. He had to make up a story. He told the landlords the houses required were for shooting a film. Those who would stay in the house were 'film extras', Ranganath added.[12]

But even though Ranganath tried to stay cool about giving shelter to Rajiv Gandhi's killers, his wife Mridula could not. She was terrified about the consequences but didn't know how to defy her husband when he was getting paid for it. Suresh Master would use the couple as much as he could, from shifting the injured from nursing homes to the rented houses and